

Sandy Bridge soon

By beginning of 2011, Intel plans to have a huge number of Sandy Bridge (Nehalem's successor) chips – the company claims that by the end of 2010, 3 per cent of all chips will be Sandy Bridge

Intel's new SSD plans

Their new 25nm fabrication not withstanding, Intel has decided to use Enterprise-grade MLC flash cells for their upcoming desktop range of SSDs based on the new fab

Bazaar

Hitachi Simple Tough 500 GB

Rugged demeanour, decent performance

One glance at this portable 500 GB hard drive from Hitachi is enough to impress anyone. Simple-Tough's rugged design includes strong rubber padding on either side of the drive and an intricately designed in-built wrap around USB cord which can be hooked to the chassis on the rear side. The rubber on the side provides a great grip. The hard drive is housed in strong plastic with a white LED located close to where the wrap around USB cord starts.

We tested the drive on an Intel X58 board running an Intel Core i7 965 processor alongwith Kingston

HyperX 2 GB DDR3 RAM. It yielded impressive scores. In the synthetic HD Tach test it gave average read / write scores of 31.4 MB/s and 27.4 MB/s (8 MB) and 32.5 MB/s and 27.4 MB/s (32 MB). Data transfer tests also gave decent transfer speeds. A single 4

GB file write took 155 secs (27 MB/s) whereas a 4 GB assorted file took 195 secs (21 MB/s). Read operations took 141 secs (29 MB/s) and 139 (29.5 MB/s) secs respectively. At Rs.8,500 we feel the price is a bit on the higher side. Around Rs. 7,000 is a decent price.



Specifications

Form Factor: 2.5 inch;
Dimensions (WxDxH in mm):
100x30x150; Weight: 267
grams; Interface: USB 2.0

Contact

Redington India Ltd
Phone: +91 09 381924185
Email: balasubramanian.r@redington.co.in
Web site: www.hitachigst.com
Price: Rs. 8,500

7/10

Build Quality	8
Features	6
Performance	7
Value for money	6

Intel X25-V SATA SSD

Low cost, decent performing SSD

Specifications

Capacity: 40 GB; Form factor:
2.5 inch hard drive; Weight:
68 gms; Interface: SATA II;

Contact

Intel APAC Support
Phone: 91 80 28542105
Email: apacsupport@mailbox.intel.in
Web site: www.intel.com/in
Price: Rs. 5,500

Solid state drives are renowned for their high data transfer speeds, but due to high costs, it's not within everyone's reach. Intel's X25-V is the SSD which is meant for value users. Having a miniscule capacity of 40 GB may seem too little for storage of applications and data, but this SSD is ideal to be used as a boot drive. The fast transfer speeds can really improve the boot up time of your system. Build quality of the SSD is quite strong with a plastic ring located on top of the drive to fit it in any form factor. Intel has bundled in a

3.5 inch adapter with screws for easy installation in your system. You can use the Intel SSD toolbox to optimise the SSD (clearing out deleted data or identifying unused blocks of data for improving performance) and it also supports native command queuing which allows the SSD to queue upto 32 commands.

Synthetic benchmarks like HD Tach and SiSoft Sandra gave scores where read transfer speeds were in excess of 200 MB/s and write speeds around 45 MB/s. Real world tests like 4 GB sequential write and read was completed in 94 secs (43.5 MB/s) and 42 secs (97.5 MB/s) respectively. Whereas a 4 GB assorted write and read was completed in 98 secs (41.7 MB/s) and 44 secs (93 MB/s) respectively. The price of Rs. 5,500 may seem expensive, but it's worth the price as the performance is quite good. Ideal for enthusiasts users who are looking at improving their OS drive speeds.



6/10

Features	6
Performance	6
Build Quality	7
Value for money	6